

2.1 Templates

Spreadsheet templates make it easier to create spreadsheets that look and work similarly. The need for templates can be easily felt when a user has to frequently create spreadsheets sharing similar formulas and formatting, with just the user-entered data changing. By creating the spreadsheet once and using it as a template for every subsequent spreadsheet, considerable time and effort can be saved.

Excel comes preloaded with seven templates, and more can be freely downloaded from the Microsoft site. The preinstalled templates are displayed when the Installed Templates button in the New Spreadsheet menu—under the Office Button—is clicked. These include those designed to be used as Sales Report, Expense Report, etc. The themes on the MS site can be viewed and downloaded in the same window. The online templates are categorised and listed under the Microsoft Office Online heading. Categories like Receipts, Planners, Reports, etc., are listed here, and clicking on any of these will reveal the templates available at the Windows site. The templates can be pre-viewed and downloaded from there.



Use the preloaded templates

A user can create custom templates from normal Excel files (.xlsx) or macro-included Excel files (.xlsm), by using the Save As button to save them as ordinary templates (.xltx) or templates with macros (.xltm) respectively. If the custom template so created is saved in the default user template folder (Documents and Settings\Username\Application Data\Microsoft\Templates), this template shows up under the My Templates collection when a New Spreadsheet is created. The “New from Existing” option can be used to load a template saved elsewhere or to use an existing spreadsheet as a template.